Guided meditation · Workbook answers

Guided Meditation

Video: 45 min **Answer sheet**

This session teaches muraqaba du'a: a calm, guided way of making du'a (personal prayer) in which you picture the name of Allah, fill yourself with light and bring Him your sins, blessings, needs, problems and decisions, one by one. It is a structured process you can repeat on your own whenever life feels heavy, to find real peace by turning to Allah.

Answer sheet: the answers are in red. The reflection questions are personal, so your own answers will be in your own words and from your own life. These model answers show what the session teaches, to guide and check your thinking.

Key teachings

1. **Learning how to make du'a, not just what to say**

   We have been taught how to pray and what to say in du'a, but often not how to truly connect with Allah. The Qur'an describes Zakariyya (peace be upon him) calling on his Lord in a quiet, private call (19:3), and the Prophet ﷺ made a beautiful du'a asking Allah to place light in his heart and all around him. This session turns that du'a of light into a practice. It is called muraqaba du'a: muraqaba means being in a deeply attentive, meditative state, fully conscious that Allah is watching over you. Just as the rules of tajweed were named later to help people recite as the Prophet ﷺ recited, this method is a way to help us make du'a with the presence he had.

2. **Stage 1: see the name of Allah and let the light in**

   Dim the lights and sit comfortably. Look at the beautiful name of Allah, written in Arabic, for about a minute, then, in your mind, write the name with your eyes. Imagine that as you write it, Allah creates a beautiful, powerful light that shines down and touches your forehead. Feel that light fill your whole body. Keep returning to this image of light coming down through each of the stages that follow.

3. **Stage 2: come into His presence, then begin with His name**

   As the light fills you, remember that Allah is with you: He has always been with you and has never left you. We forget Allah, but He never forgets us. Allah sees you: at work, with your children, with your spouse and your neighbours. Allah hears you, every word you say. Then say: Bismillah ar-Rahman ar-Rahim (in the name of Allah, the Most Merciful, the Most Kind); Astaghfirullah (I seek Allah's forgiveness) three times; and send blessings on the Prophet ﷺ three times: Allahumma salli 'ala sayyidina Muhammad wa 'ala alihi wa sahbihi wa sallim.

4. **Stage 3: join creation in praising Allah, then present your sins**

   Feel yourself part of nature, as everything in creation praises Allah, even though we do not understand its praise (17:44). Feel every part of your own body praising Him too. Now bring your biggest sins to Allah with your heart: the ones you have not forgotten and have not even forgiven yourself for. Present them with regret, knowing that Allah loves to forgive and only wants you to ask. He tells us not to despair of His mercy, for He forgives all sins (39:53). Picture the light washing over you like water, wiping the sins away.

5 **Stage 4: present your greatest blessings**

As the light keeps coming down, bring Allah your greatest blessings and reflect on each one: your health; your family and children; the safety around you; your wealth; your iman (faith) and the guidance you were given; having the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ; and your parents. Thank Allah for them, because He has promised that if we are grateful, He will increase us (14:7).

6 **Stages 5 and 6: present your needs, then your problems**

Next, bring your greatest needs and really feel them: the job you have applied for, your children settling into school, being able to afford a car, a promotion at work, or growing in tazkiyah (purifying the soul) to come closer to Allah. Allah loves to hear your needs and loves to answer them; He says that when His servants ask about Him, He is near and answers the one who calls (2:186). Then bring your problems, especially those you have found no solution to: conflict in the family, difficulties with a spouse, a child who does not seem to understand, siblings who have drifted away, parents who do not understand you, things in the house you cannot fix, bills you cannot cover, being stuck at work. Ask Allah to solve them, because He can do all things. We just have to ask.

7 **Stages 7 and 8: hand over your decisions, then close the treasure chest**

Now bring Allah any decisions you need to make: which school to choose for your children, whether to stay in your job or look for a new one, whether to start that business, whether to take a risk. Allah knows everything and knows what is best for us, even when we do not. Finally, gather everything you have presented (your sins, blessings, needs, problems and decisions) and picture a beautiful treasure chest in front of you, covered in gold, rubies and diamonds. Slowly open it, place everything inside and close it. Feel the weight lift off your chest as you send it all to Allah.

8 **Making it part of your daily routine**

Try to do this regularly, because life is stressful. When we take our problems to people, they are often not interested or cannot help, so turn to Allah instead. With sin, the deeper problem is not turning back to Allah afterwards, and when we thank Him for blessings, He gives us more. If you could not see the name of Allah, do not worry: it gets better with practice. Sometimes something is holding you back, such as needing to forgive someone, or treating someone unfairly. Goosebumps, good feelings and good dreams are welcome, but they are not the goal. The goal is presence with Allah and showing mercy to His creation. Keep it simple and make du'a from the heart: you do not need lots of special words, just follow the structure.

From the Qur'an and the Sunnah

> *O Allah, place light in my heart, light on my tongue, light in my hearing and light in my sight; light above me and light below me, light on my right and light on my left, light in front of me and light behind me; place light in my soul and make the light great for me.*
>
> **Sahih Muslim**

تُسَبِّحُ لَهُ ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتُ ٱلسَّبْعُ وَٱلْأَرْضُ وَمَن فِيهِنَّ ۚ وَإِن مِّن شَىْءٍ إِلَّا يُسَبِّحُ بِحَمْدِهِۦ وَلَٰكِن لَّا تَفْقَهُونَ تَسْبِيحَهُمْ ۗ إِنَّهُۥ كَانَ حَلِيمًا غَفُورًا

The seven heavens and the earth and whatever is in them exalt Him. And there is not a thing except that it exalts [Allāh] by His praise, but you do not understand their [way of] exalting. Indeed, He is ever Forbearing and Forgiving.

Surah al-Isra 17:44

قُلْ يَٰعِبَادِيَ ٱلَّذِينَ أَسْرَفُوا۟ عَلَىٰٓ أَنفُسِهِمْ لَا تَقْنَطُوا۟ مِن رَّحْمَةِ ٱللَّهِ ۚ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ يَغْفِرُ ٱلذُّنُوبَ جَمِيعًا ۚ إِنَّهُۥ هُوَ ٱلْغَفُورُ ٱلرَّحِيمُ

Say, "O My servants who have transgressed against themselves [by sinning], do not despair of the mercy of Allāh. Indeed, Allāh forgives all sins. Indeed, it is He who is the Forgiving, the Merciful."

Surah az-Zumar 39:53

وَإِذْ تَأَذَّنَ رَبُّكُمْ لَئِن شَكَرْتُمْ لَأَزِيدَنَّكُمْ ۖ وَلَئِن كَفَرْتُمْ إِنَّ عَذَابِى لَشَدِيدٌ

And [remember] when your Lord proclaimed, 'If you are grateful, I will surely increase you [in favor]; but if you deny, indeed, My punishment is severe.'

Surah Ibrahim 14:7

وَإِذَا سَأَلَكَ عِبَادِى عَنِّى فَإِنِّى قَرِيبٌ ۖ أُجِيبُ دَعْوَةَ ٱلدَّاعِ إِذَا دَعَانِ ۖ فَلْيَسْتَجِيبُوا۟ لِى وَلْيُؤْمِنُوا۟ بِى لَعَلَّهُمْ يَرْشُدُونَ

And when My servants ask you, [O Muḥammad], concerning Me - indeed I am near. I respond to the invocation of the supplicant when he calls upon Me. So let them respond to Me [by obedience] and believe in Me that they may be [rightly] guided.

Surah al-Baqarah 2:186

> *The Prophet ﷺ advised the young Abdullah ibn Abbas: "Be mindful of Allah and He will protect you. Be mindful of Allah and you will find Him before you. When you ask, ask Allah, and when you seek help, seek help from Allah."*
>
> **Sunan at-Tirmidhi**

Practical exercises

Muraqaba du'a: do it yourself (10 to 15 minutes)

1. Dim the lights, sit comfortably and look at the name of Allah for a minute. Close your eyes and write it with your eyes.
2. Picture light from Allah touching your forehead and filling your body. Remember: Allah is with me, sees me and hears me.
3. Say Bismillah ar-Rahman ar-Rahim, Astaghfirullah three times, and send blessings on the Prophet ﷺ three times.
4. Feel all of creation praising Allah, then present to Him, one at a time: your sins, your blessings, your needs, your problems and your decisions.
5. Place everything in a golden treasure chest, close it, and feel the weight lift as you send it to Allah.
6. Afterwards, write down anything you felt or noticed.

Before and after: how did it change me?

1. Before you begin, score how calm you feel from 1 to 10, and write the one thing weighing on you most.
2. Do the muraqaba du'a above, then score your calm again from 1 to 10.
3. Write what feels lighter now, and which stage moved you most.
4. Note one thing you will do differently next time.

7-day practice: muraqaba du'a

Tick each day you practise.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Did the muraqaba du'a							
Thanked Allah for my blessings							
Handed a problem or decision to Allah							
Turned to Allah first when something worried me							

Reflection questions and answers

1. How did you usually make du'a before? What felt different this time?

> Many of us were taught what to say in du'a (personal prayer) but not how to truly connect with Allah. Muraqaba du'a gives a structure: see the name of Allah, let the light in, come into His presence, then bring Him your sins, blessings, needs, problems and decisions one by one, like Zakariyya's quiet, private call (19:3). For example: "I used to rush through a list of requests after salah. This time it felt like a real conversation, and I came away lighter."

2. Could you see the name of Allah? If not, could something be holding you back?

> If you could not see the name of Allah, there is no need to worry: it gets better with practice. Sometimes, though, something is holding you back, such as needing to forgive someone or having treated someone unfairly. For example: "I only saw it faintly. When I thought about it, I realised I was still holding a grudge against a relative, so I want to forgive them and try again."

3. Which stage was hardest for you, and why do you think that is?

> Many people find presenting their sins the hardest stage, especially the ones they have never forgiven themselves for. Allah tells us not to despair of His mercy, for He forgives all sins (39:53); He loves to forgive and only wants us to ask. Others find the problems or decisions stage hard because they are used to carrying everything themselves. For example: "The sins stage was hardest, but picturing the light washing over me like water helped me let go."

4. Which blessing did you realise you had been taking for granted?

> The blessings named in the session are your health, your family and children, the safety around you, your wealth, your iman (faith) and the guidance you were given, having the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, and your parents. Allah promises that if we are grateful, He will increase us (14:7). For example: "I had never really thanked Allah for the safety around me: being able to walk my children to school without fear."

5. What problem or decision did you put in the treasure chest, and how do you feel about it now?

> In the last stage you gather everything you have presented, place it in a treasure chest covered in gold, rubies and diamonds, close it and send it to Allah, feeling the weight lift. People often cannot help with our problems, but Allah knows what is best even when we do not, and He can do all things. For example: "I put in my decision about changing jobs. I still have to act, but I no longer feel I am carrying it alone."

My action plan

- [ ] I will do the muraqaba du'a at least once a day this week, at a set time.
- [ ] I will bring my worries to Allah first, before I take them to people.
- [ ] When I slip into a sin, I will turn back to Allah straight away and ask His forgiveness.
- [ ] I will thank Allah for one blessing each day, by name.
- [ ] I will not chase special feelings, but focus on being present with Allah and kind to others.